



Entrepreneurial Strategy

Strategic Marketing MSc

The Problem

GIFTING IS MEANINGFUL, BUT TOO OFTEN **STRESSFUL, UNCERTAIN, AND TIME-CONSUMING.**



1 Uncertainty Creates Stress

Consumers often do not know what the recipient actually wants, creating anxiety, decision fatigue, and last-minute choices.



2 Too Many Choices, Too Little Clarity

Search is fragmented across platforms, leading to generic gift ideas, mental overload, and lower confidence.



3 The Process Takes Too Much Time

Researching, comparing, and deciding is inefficient, making gifting feel more effortful than enjoyable.



4 Low Confidence Reduces Impact

Many givers worry their gift will miss the mark, leaving the experience feeling less personal and less memorable.



The result: *gifting becomes emotionally risky, time-consuming, and harder to do well.*

Survey Validation

REAL PEOPLE. REAL GIFTING STRUGGLES. REAL MARKET DEMAND.



113

Total Respondents

Target consumers who regularly purchase gifts.



May 2026

Survey Dates

Recent consumer research validating market demand.



100%

Target Market Fit

All respondents aligned with gift's intended customer profile.

“

I care deeply about making people feel seen and appreciated

I just need help figuring out what would actually mean something to them.

”



This was the recurring emotional theme across responses:

Consumers care deeply about gifting but feel uncertain about how to do it well.



Gifting Frequency



- Gifting is not an occasional behavior, it's a recurring, year-round activity.



- We found that over 70% of respondents purchase gifts at least three times per year, validating gifting as a consistent consumer behaviour rather than a seasonal one.

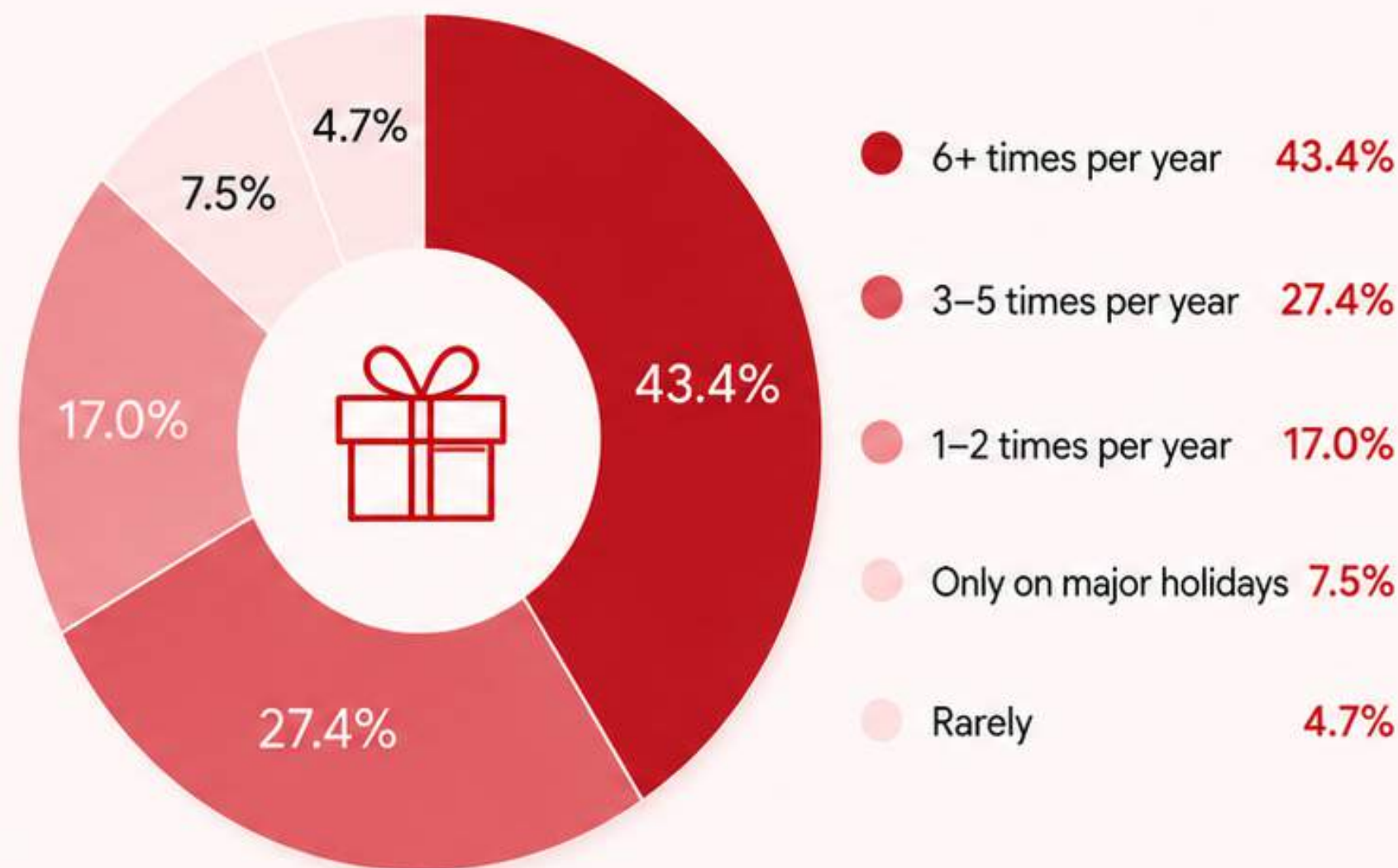


- This frequency creates strong engagement potential for a platform like gift'd. Gifting occasions extend beyond just birthdays and holidays; they encompass other events like milestones, parties, and other spontaneous moments throughout the year.



- This shows that gifting is a high-frequency emotional behavior with long-term retention potential.

Most respondents buy gifts multiple times a year.



70.8% gift 3+ times per year, strong validation for a year-round solution.

Gifting Struggle

Finding the perfect gift feels harder than it should.



#1 Pain Point: “I don’t know what they actually want.”



The majority of respondents struggle because they simply **do not know** what the recipient actually wants.



This uncertainty **creates stress**, leads to generic gift choices, and often results in last-minute purchasing behavior.



The challenge is not access to products — consumers already have endless shopping options. The challenge is **emotional confidence**: people want to give meaningful gifts, but they lack confidence in their ability to choose the right one.



This insight positions gft’d as a solution focused on **confidence and personalization**, not just commerce.

What makes finding the perfect gift so hard?



Not knowing what they want



Last-minute / panic buying



Staying within budget



Generic / unoriginal ideas



Too many choices



Not knowing their style



Shipping / delivery stress



Other



Gift Search

A FRAGMENTED, MANUAL, AND TIME-CONSUMING PROCESS.



Consumers are currently relying on **fragmented and inefficient methods** to discover gift ideas.



Most respondents **search across multiple platforms** including friends and family, Google, Amazon, Pinterest, social media, and even AI tools. Despite this effort, many still feel unsure about their final decision.

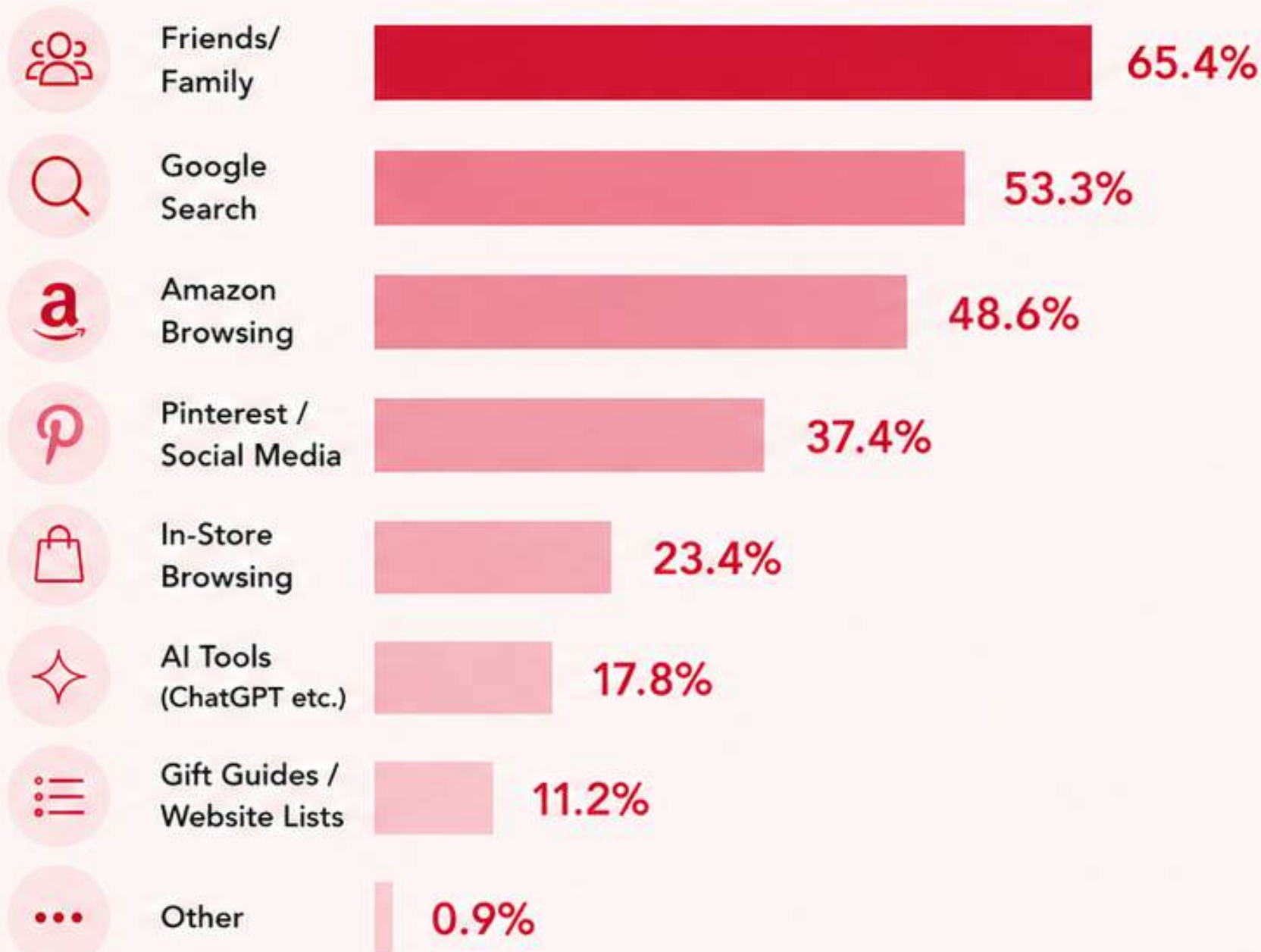


This behavior highlights a **major gap** in the market: consumers are actively searching for gifting support, but **no single platform** is delivering emotionally intelligent, personalized recommendations in one place.



The emergence of AI tools in the data also validates growing openness to **AI-assisted gifting experiences**.

How do people go about searching for gifts?



People are **searching everywhere** — and still not confident in their choices.

Gifting Satisfaction Gap



- **Nearly 90%** of respondents describe their gifts as “decent” or say they “could be better,” revealing a significant **emotional satisfaction gap**.



- Consumers clearly **care about gifting** and want to make others feel appreciated, but most feel they are falling short of delivering gifts that accomplish this.

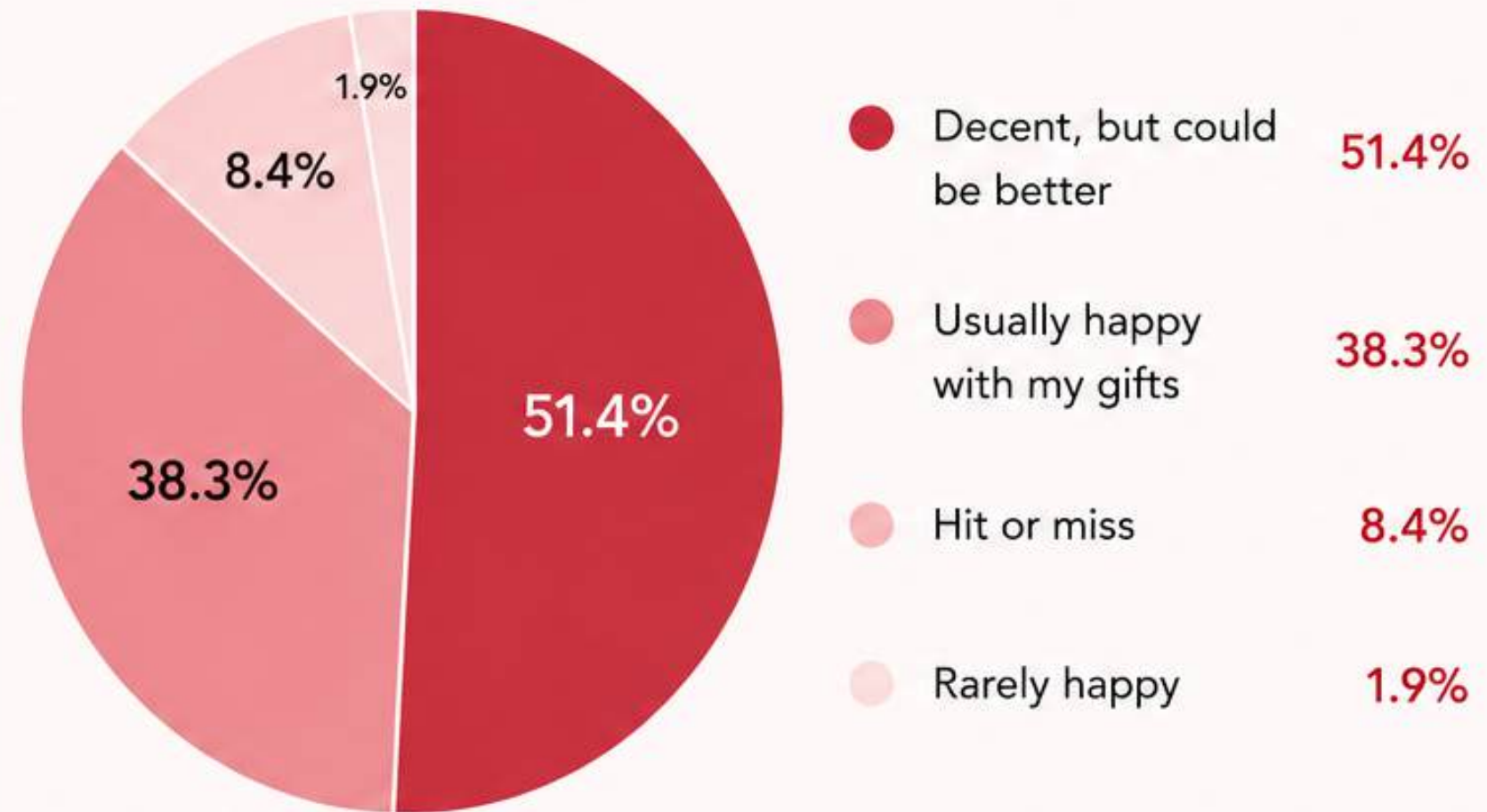


- This creates a strong opportunity for gft'd to **improve emotional outcomes** rather than simply streamline transactions.



- The opportunity is not just helping users buy gifts – it is helping them **feel successful** as gift givers.

How do people feel about the gifts they give?



High dissatisfaction = high opportunity for gft'd.

Customer WTP- Van Westendorp Test



The data shows strong purchasing intent and healthy spending behavior within gifting categories.



The largest consumer segment is comfortable spending between £5–£6 per month on gift, with an additional portion willing to spend between £7–£10. This demonstrates that consumers are **willing to invest financially** when they believe the service will result in a gift that feels thoughtful and meaningful.



The results reinforce that **value perception** is tied more closely to **relevance** and **emotional impact** than to price alone.

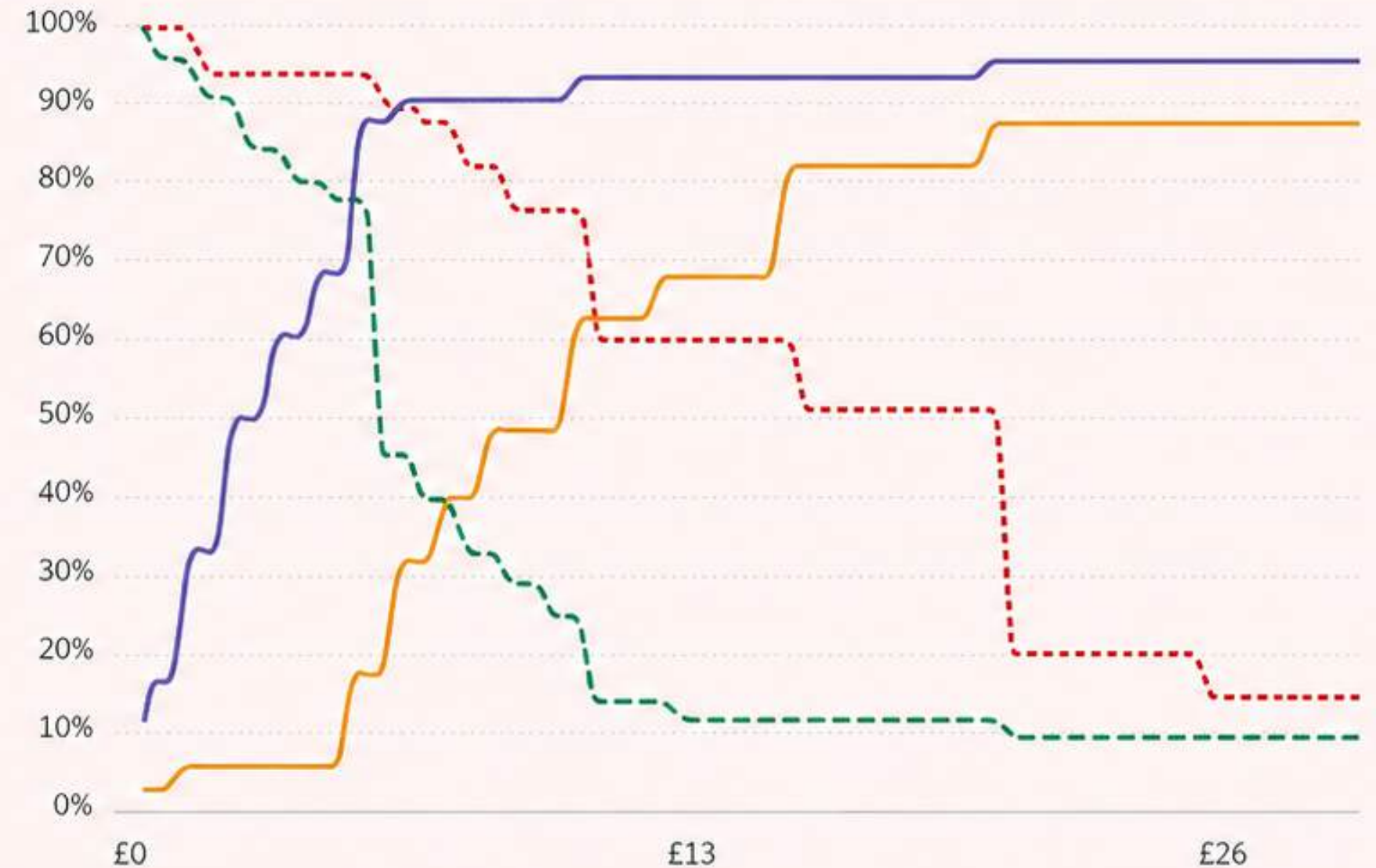
Q1: “At what price would you question if it works?”

Q2: “At what price would it feel like great value?”

Q3: “At what price would you hesitate but still consider?”

Q4: “At what price would you not subscribe no matter what?”

● Too Cheap ● Too Expensive ● Getting Expensive ● Bargain



Hesitations With gft'd



The primary barriers to adoption are **trust and perceived personalization quality**.



Respondents expressed concern that recommendations could still feel **generic**, while others raised questions around privacy, **value**, and whether the platform would truly understand recipients on a personal level.



This insight reinforces the importance of positioning gft'd as a **highly personalized, emotionally intelligent, and trustworthy platform** from the beginning.



Building recommendation quality and **consumer trust** will be critical to long-term retention.

What might hold them back?



Too expensive

42.1%



Recommendations might still feel generic

30.6%



Privacy / sharing concerns

23.4%



Already use other methods that work

21.5%



Too many apps / overwhelm

16.8%



Don't trust AI recommendations

15.0%



Other

2.8%



**TRUST & VALUE
ARE KEY.**

People need confidence that gft'd is personal, private, and worth it.

gft'd = No-Brainer

THE FEATURES THAT MATTER MOST DRIVE ADOPTION.



- Consumers are looking for solutions that **reduce stress** while **increasing emotional relevance**.



- The strongest drivers of adoption include **saving time, receiving highly personalized recommendations, and getting reminders for important occasions**. Consumers also responded positively to wishlist integration and curated gifting experiences.



- The data suggests that the ideal gifting platform **combines convenience with emotional intelligence**, which gft'd will be able to provide. Users want to feel both efficient and thoughtful.

Top features & benefits respondents said would win them over.



73.8%

Easy to use
& saves time



67.3%

Highly personalized
recommendations



56.1%

Reminders for
occasions



49.5%

See friends'
wishlists



42.1%

Exclusive deals /
discounts



28.0%

Curated gift
bundles

“

If it helps me truly get them, without the stress, I'm in.

”

What Matters Most to Consumers



Consumers consistently defined meaningful gifts through **emotional qualities** rather than monetary value.



The strongest themes included **thoughtfulness, personalization, effort, relevance, and demonstrating genuine understanding** of the recipient's interests and personality.



Respondent quotes reinforced a central insight: people do not necessarily want expensive gifts they want gifts that make others feel **seen and understood**.



This insight sits at the **core of gift'd's positioning and product vision**.

What makes a gift meaningful?

Top Themes

- ✓ Thoughtfulness & effort
- ✓ Personalization
- ✓ Knowing their interests
- ✓ Quality over price
- ✓ Timing & relevance

Respondent Quotes

“

“The best gifts show that the person really knows me.”

“It’s not about the price — it’s about the thought behind it.”

“When they listen to the little things I say, that’s when it hits.”

”

The Solution: gft'd

AI-POWERED GIFTING THAT MAKES IT **EASY, PERSONAL, AND MEANINGFUL.**



Eliminates Uncertainty

gft'd asks the right questions and uses AI to understand the recipient deeply so you always know what they'll love.



Personalized, Not Generic

AI matches unique interests, personality, and context to deliver highly personalized recommendations in seconds.



Saves Time & Effort

From discovery to checkout, gft'd streamlines every step so you can find the perfect gift without the hours of research.



Builds Confidence

Feel confident that your gift will be meaningful, appreciated, and create a lasting impression.



Delivers Meaningful Impact

Stronger relationships, more joyful moments, and the satisfaction of giving the perfect gift, every time.

How it Works

[Click here to see animation](#)



1

Meet Ribbon

Our AI assistant introduces and guides the gifting journey

2

Create Your Gifter Profile

Users complete a quick profile and gifting-style quiz, allowing gft'd to assign a playful personality type that personalises the experience from the start

3

Create Recipient Profile

Users share the recipient's relationship, interests, occasion, and preferences

4

Explore Personalized Gift Ideas

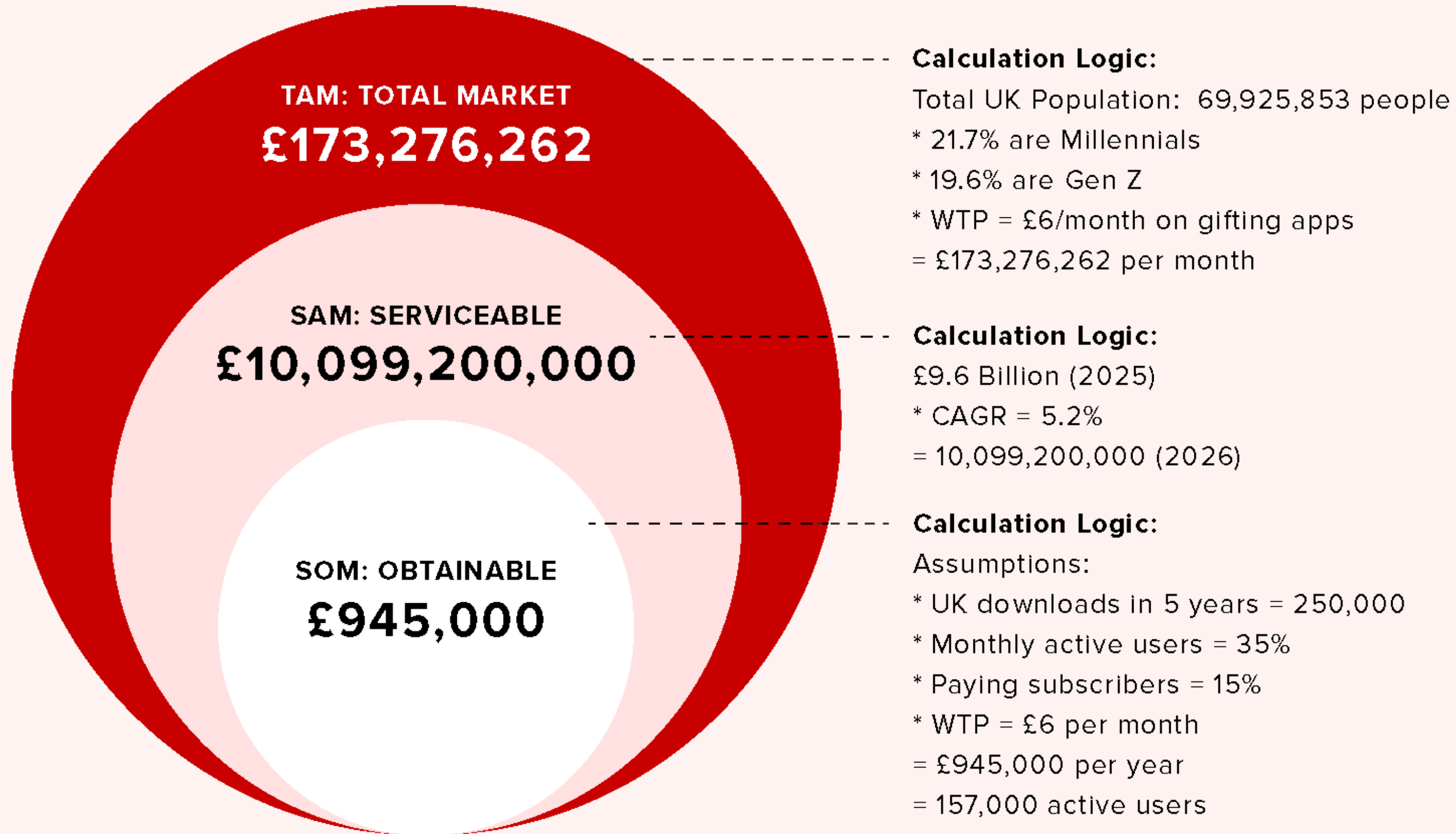
Gftd generates visual gift recommendations tailored to the recipient, budget, occasion, and the user's gifting style

5

Compare, Refresh, and Refine

Ribbon explains the reasoning behind each recommendation, compares options, and helps users refine or refresh their gift ideas

Market Sizing

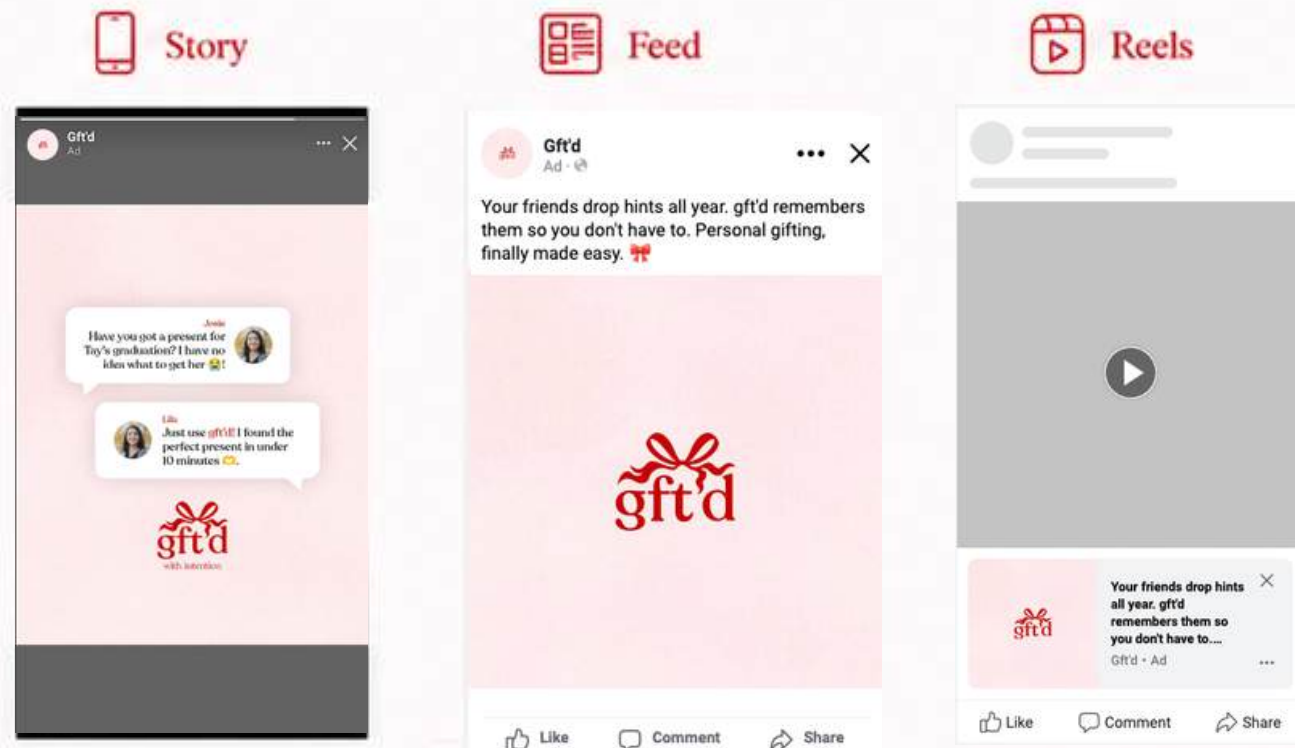


Paid Acquisition Validation

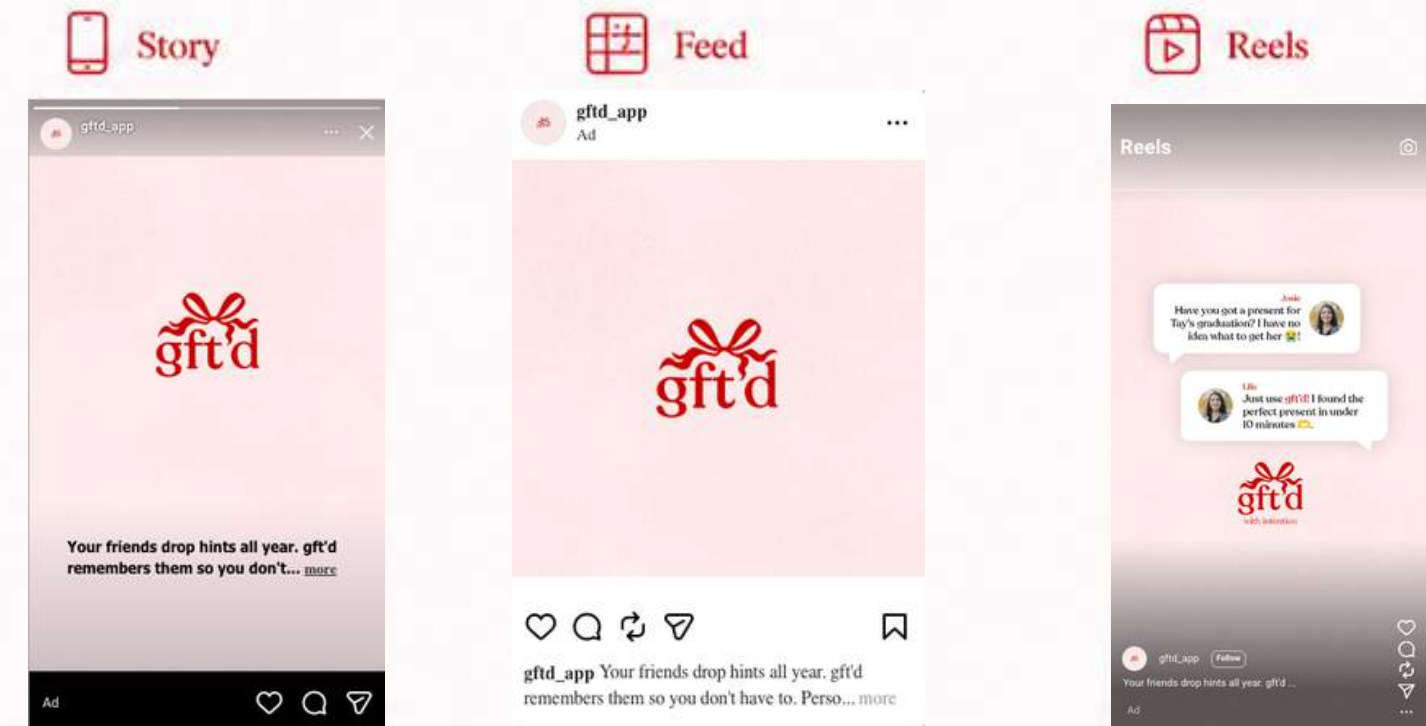
Testing Objective

We deployed identical creative assets across Meta's highest-engagement placements to evaluate acquisition performance under controlled messaging conditions.

Facebook Deployment



Instagram Deployment



Consistent Testing Environment

Creatives were deployed simultaneously across Facebook and Instagram Stories, Feeds, and Reels using the same visual assets, messaging, and targeting strategy. This allowed us to isolate platform and placement performance while maintaining a consistent brand narrative:

"Your friends drop hints all year. gft'd remembers them so you don't have to."

Standardized deployment across six Meta placements enabled clean measurement of audience response and acquisition performance.

Low-Cost Concept Testing Generated Early Interest From Target Users

Meta advertising campaign targeting UK consumers to validate initial demand for *gift'd*



Campaign Setup



Location
United Kingdom

Total Spend
£19



Audience
Age 18–65+

Objective
Traffic, Learn More CTA



Placements
Instagram,
Facebook

Versions Tested
2 creative concepts



Duration
7 Days

Targeting Interests
Gift giving, Etsy, Pinterest,
Engaged Shoppers



Performance Overview



Reach

Ad Set #1

Ad Set #2

890

1,877



Cost Per Result

£0.06

£0.97



Impressions

993

1,953



Is there demand? Who responds? And at what cost can we reach them? Ad Set #1 answered all three.

Demand exists, our customer is a woman aged 25–34, and we can reach her at £0.06 per engaged action. That is the foundation of a scalable, capital-efficient growth model.



Early results show strong interest at low cost, validating demand and our ability to reach high-intent users efficiently.

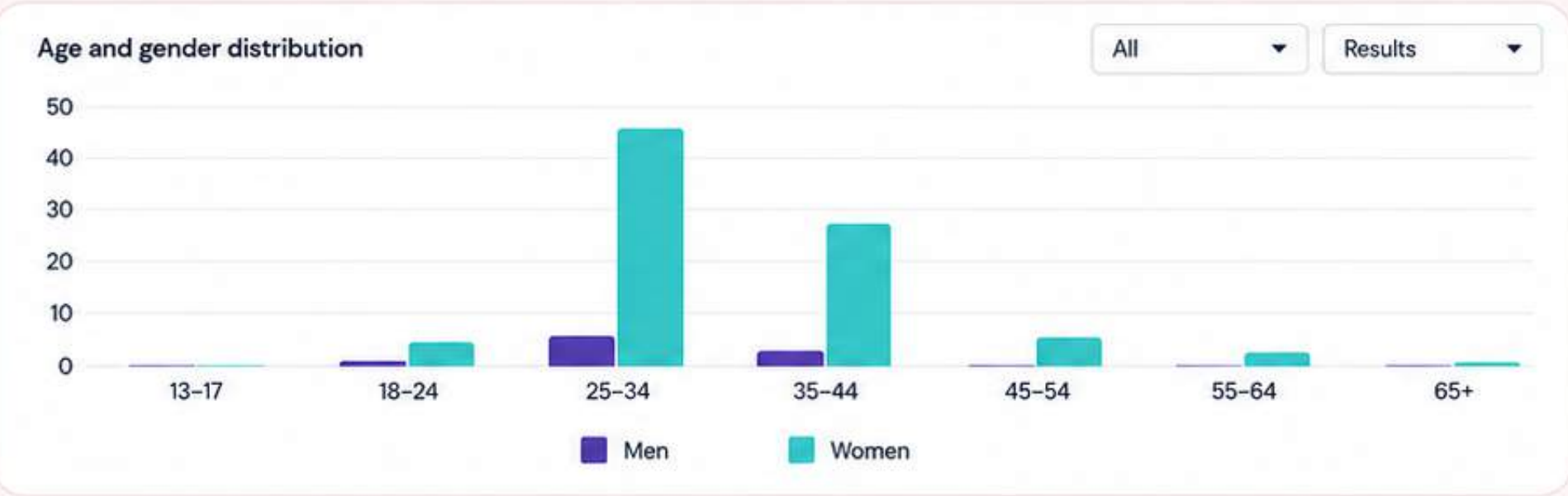
Audience Discovery Revealed a Clear Customer Profile

Cross-platform demographic testing revealed a decisive audience split.



Ad Set #1: Instagram

✓ ICP Validated



Target Customer Found

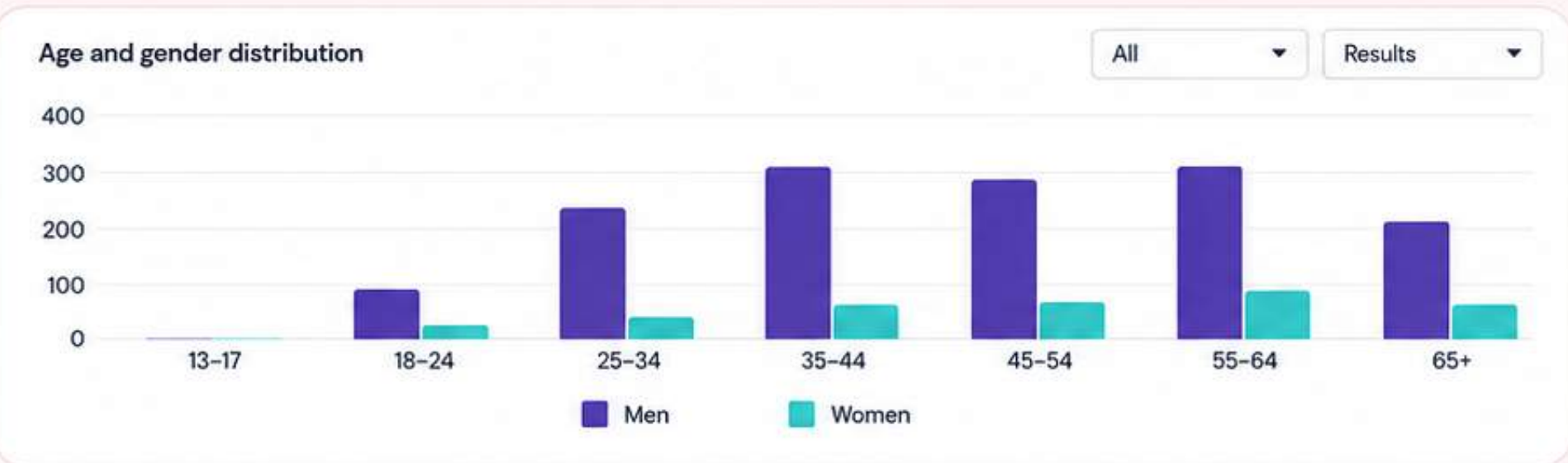
- ✓ 90% Female
- ✓ Peak Age: 25-34
- ✓ Highest engagement concentration
- ✓ Strong ICP alignment

Instagram attracted a 90% female audience peaking at ages 25-34 — our exact ICP.

The platform delivered a highly concentrated audience that aligns directly with our target customer profile.

Ad Set #2: Facebook

Secondary Channel



Broader Audience Reach

- ✓ Predominantly male
- ✓ Distributed age profile
- ✓ Lower ICP concentration
- ✓ Less efficient targeting signal

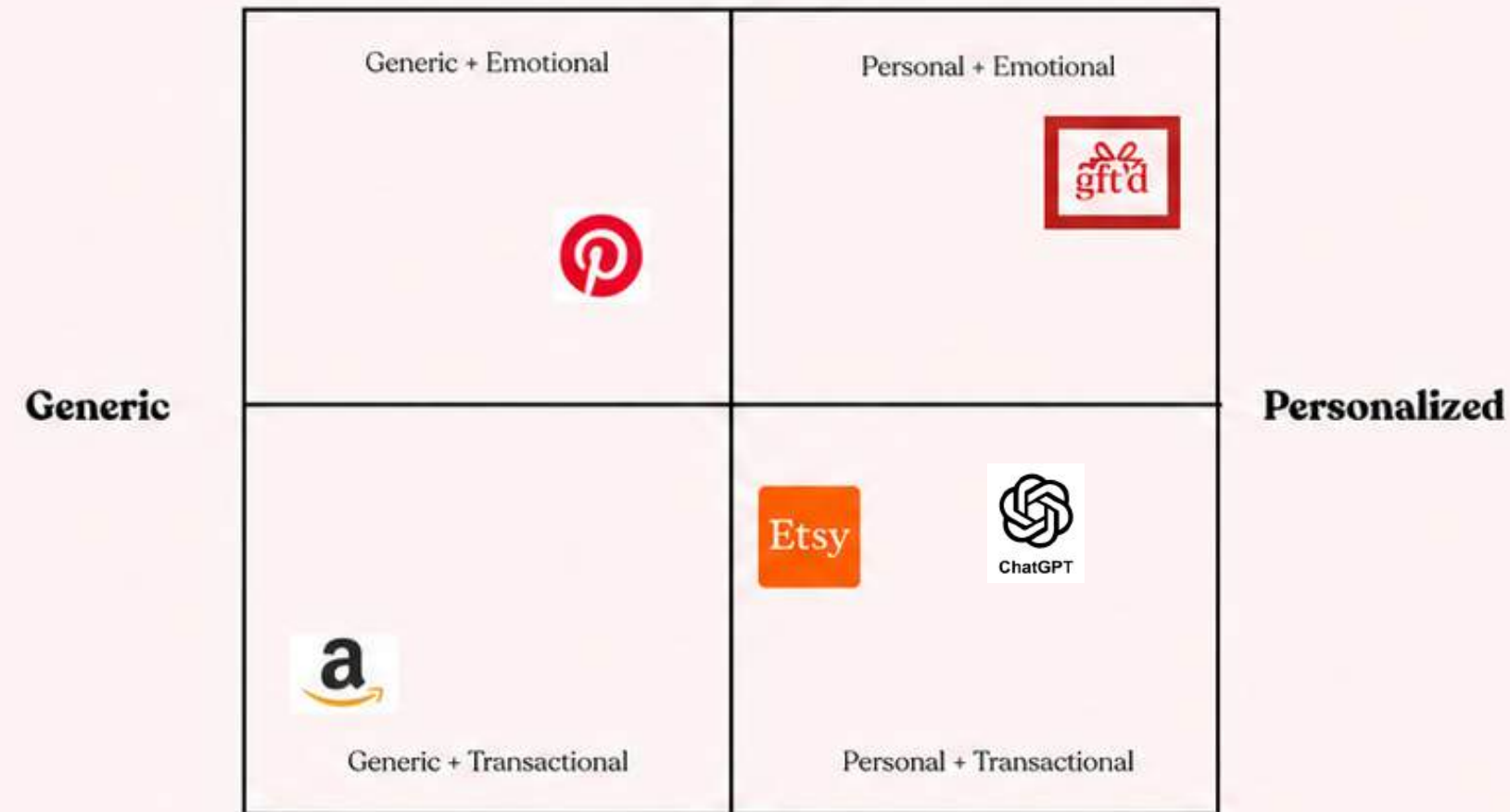
Facebook reached a predominantly male, broadly distributed audience with no meaningful concentration in our target segment.

It generated reach but delivered weaker alignment with our ideal customer.

Instagram emerged as the primary acquisition channel, delivering the strongest alignment with our ideal customer profile.

Positioned at the Only White Space

Emotionally Focused



Transaction Focused



The Market Today

Existing platforms compete in isolated quadrants — either emotionally focused or transactional, either generic or personalized.



Our Differentiation

gft'd is the only solution that combines deep personalization with emotional relevance — solving gifting the way people actually think about each other.



Amazon
knows products.



Pinterest
knows aesthetics.



Etsy
knows makers.



ChatGPT
knows language.

None of them know *people*.

gft'd lives at the intersection of who it's for and why it matters.

Competitor Comparison Table



 Competitor	 Core Strength	 Core Weakness	 Why gift'd Wins
Amazon	Unmatched product selection, logistics, and price comparison	Zero relationship context, treats every gift search as a new, anonymous transaction	gift'd retains recipient profiles and occasion history, the purchase decision is already half-made before the user opens the app
Pinterest	Visual inspiration and trend discovery at scale	No bridge from inspiration to purchase; no gifting intent, planning, or execution	Pinterest generates ideas; gift'd generated decisions. The user's job-to-be-done is not to feel inspired, it is to buy the right thing
Etsy	Unique, handcrafted, and personalised products from independent sellers	Pure marketplace with no gifting intelligence layer; no occasion awareness, recipient memory, or recommendation engine	Etsy is where you buy once you know what you want. gift'd is how you figure out what to get - the two are potentially complementary, not directly competitive
ChatGPT	Flexible, conversational, capable of nuanced suggestions	Stateless by default, no persistent memory of recipient; quality of output entirely dependent on quality of user input	gift'd recipient profiles do the contextual work automatically. Users should not need to be good prompters to find a good gift.

Competitor Analysis

HOW WE COMPARE



FEATURES	amazon	Etsy	<i>Pinterest</i>	ChatGPT	gift'd
EMOTIONAL PERSONALIZATION	Low	Medium	Medium	Medium	High
OCCASION PLANNING	No	No	No	Limited	Yes
RECIPIENT MEMORY	No	No	No	No	Yes
AI GIFTING ASSISTANCE	Minimal	Minimal	No	Generic	Personalized
WISHLIST INTEGRATION	Limited	Limited	Inspiration Only	No	Yes
CURATED GIFT RECOMMENDATIONS	Low	Medium	Medium	Low	High
FOCUS	Transactional Commerce	Marketplace	Inspiration Discovery	Information Tool	Emotional Gifting Experience

Why We Win



We're building the first AI-powered relationship intelligence platform
designed *specifically for gifting*.



Deep Relationship Intelligence

We capture and understand the context behind every relationship, occasion and preference — building a proprietary Relationship Memory Graph that gets smarter with every gift.



AI That Feels Personal

Our AI goes beyond suggestions. It understands people, occasions and intent — delivering recommendations that feel thoughtful, not generic.



Occasion-Aware by Design

We anticipate important moments and help users plan ahead, so they never forget, never panic-buy, and always give with intention.



Built for the Emotional Outcome

We focus on the feeling behind the gift — helping users make others feel seen, appreciated and known. That emotional outcome drives loyalty.



Commerce That Complements

We combine inspiration, personalisation and seamless shopping with affiliate partnerships that create value for users and sustainable revenue for gft'd.



Our goal isn't just to help people find gifts.
It's to help people give gifts that make others feel *truly known*.



Business Model

Feature	The Starter (Free)	The Planner (£5.99 / mo)	The Curator (£8.99 / mo)
 AI Gift Assistant	Limited chats	Expanded chats	Unlimited priority chats
 Recipient Profiles	3 profiles	Unlimited	Unlimited
 One-Time Gift Profiles	2/month	10/month	Unlimited
 Gift Recommendations	Basic	Personalized	Highly personalized + concierge-style
 Gift Calendar & Reminders	Basic reminders	Advanced reminders	Automated planning
 Budget-Based Suggestions	Basic budget filter	Full budget tracking	Budget + savings tools
 Wishlist & Shopping Links	Save limited ideas	Unlimited wishlist + links	Wishlist + deeper shopping integrations

Go-To-Market Strategy



WHO WE TARGET

Early adopters



Gen Z & Millennials



Young professionals



Students



Social gifters



WHEN THEY USE IT

Year-round gifting moments



Birthdays & Holidays



Anniversaries & Weddings



Graduations & Milestones



Housewarmings &
Workplace Gifting



HOW WE REACH THEM

Scalable acquisition channels



TikTok & Instagram



Influencer Partnerships



SEO Gift Guides



Brand Partnerships



Focused audience. Year-round occasions. Repeat usage.

Team & Resources



CORE TEAM



Product Vision



Customer Insight



Brand & Marketing



Growth Partnerships



SPECIALIST SUPPORT



App & AI Build



Privacy & Security



Payment Systems



Shopping Integrations



STRATEGIC ADVISORS



E-commerce Strategy



Consumer Behaviour



Data Protection



Retail Partnerships



Scaling Guidance

Our core team shapes the customer insight, product vision, and growth strategy, while specialist support and advisors bring the technical and commercial expertise needed to build, protect, and scale gft'd.

Use of Funds

Ask: £85,000

Funding Bucket	Amount	Share of Ask	What it Covers	Why it Matters	Model Basis / Source
Core AI MVP Build	£25,000	29.4%	Product strategy, UX/UI, app build, AI/API integration, backend, QA, legal setup, landing page and initial launch tests	Turns the concept into a testable product investors can see and users can trial	Benchmarked against UK MVP/app-build ranges and itemized build tab
24-Month Operating Runway	£48,000	56.5%	AI/API usage, hosting, tools, analytics, developer maintenance, marketing experiments, customer support and compliance updates	Keeps the MVP live long enough to learn from users, improve retention and show traction	Monthly Runway sheet uses £2,000/month × 24 months
Contingency Reserve	£10,950	12.9%	Unexpected build revisions, API/cloud overruns, legal/privacy support, QA fixes and paid-test variance	Reduces the risk of underfunding the MVP during early iteration	15% of build + operating subtotal
Rounding/Flexibility Buffer	£1,050	1.2%	Extra flexibility from rounding the calculated need to a clean £85,000 ask	Makes the pitch cleaner while preserving a small buffer for minor changes	£85,000 less calculated need of £83,950
Total	£85,000	100.0%	Full recommended ask	Target ask to center funding priorities	Sum of funding bucket

Funding Milestones

 Phase	 Timeline	 Funding Bucket	 Milestone	 Main Activities	 Investor Evidence Produced	 Why This Layout Exists
1. Scope	Weeks 1–2	Core AI MVP Build	Define focused MVP	Finalize recipient profile fields, recommendation logic, core screens and build priorities	Clear MVP scope and reduced overbuild risk	Shows the ask funds a controlled build rather than vague product spending.
2. Prototype	Weeks 3–5	Core AI MVP Build	Design investor/testable	Create Figma prototypes, onboarding, recipient profiles, AI suggestions, saved ideas and reminders	Clickable demo for user testing and investor presentation	Connects design spend to tangible outputs.
3. Build	Weeks 6–12	Core AI MVP Build	Develop working MVP	Build account/profile flow, AI recommendations, database, saved ideas and basic analytics	Functional MVP ready for beta users	Shows product risk is being reduced early.
4. Validate	Months 4–6	Runway + Marketing	Run beta and acquisition tests	Test recommendation quality, onboarding, paid social, conversion and qualitative feedback	Activation, retention and acquisition insights	Links runway to learning, not passive spending.
5. Iterate	Months 7–18	Runway + Maintenance	Improve product and retention	Fix bugs, improve prompts, refine user journey and test key seasonal moments	Improved retention and conversion data	Shows why runway is needed beyond launch.
6. Prepare to scale	Months 19–24	Runway + Contingency	Build case for next funding step	Package metrics, improve compliance, prepare partnerships and next-round narrative	Evidence for seed/grant/loan follow-on	Shows what £85,000 unlocks before the next capital raise.

Funding Sources

FUNDING SOURCE	TARGET AMOUNT	SHARE OF ASK	TIMING	PLANNED USE
UK Start Up Loan	£25,000	29.4%	Initial funding route	Fund the first phase of MVP build, product strategy, UX/UI, app prototype, AI/API setup, and early testing.
Early Investors / Angels	£50,000	58.8%	Pre-seed / early validation round	Extend runway, fund AI/product development, user testing, paid acquisition experiments, analytics, and product iteration.
Founder Bootstrapping	£10,000	11.8%	Pre-launch and alongside fundraising	Cover early non-core costs such as research, prototype tools, branding, website setup, pitch materials, testing incentives, and admin costs.
Total Initial Funding Plan	£85,000	100%	MVP / pre-seed phase	Takes gt'd from concept to working MVP, early user testing, and investor-ready traction evidence.
Future scale option	Growth Guarantee Scheme	Later-stage scale funding	Post-MVP / scale phase	Potential later debt funding to support hiring, partnerships, product expansion, marketing scale-up, and infrastructure.



gift'd turns gifting from
a stressful search into an
**intentional, personalised
experience.**

Making gifting easier,
smarter, and more personal.

